

sundays

mother only feeds me on sundays.

mother only feeds me after words unspilled, wrists unslit, tears unfallen.
i am fed with hands tied, blindfolded. mother scrapes her fingers raw on my teeth. i savour until
my tongue tires of the poison.

mother tells me she never waited for sundays.

i have a secret; i mustn't tell. will never muster up the courage to talk about violent nights and
aftermath mornings. tracing back the roots of her life, sprawling and sparse, i see her truth
through the gray hairs.

mother does not get fed.

mother becomes amma becomes child. child is laughter and eagerness and befriending your
daughter. she is seeing you through a mirror and stroking your imperfections, your potential. you
never learned to refuse.

mother forgets fear breeds resentment.

mother doesn't need to "listen." mother knows her youth, ignores scars and broken eggshells.
mother imparts, lipstick fingerprint to cheek, nesting dolls of confusion/broken/hate. mother sees
red and forgets to see love.

mother is scared.

hands shake and body flushes red pressed to the floor. daughter panics cries forgets, book
fluttering shut and stomping in the distance. sound travels well in small apartments. guilt travels
better in the bodies of little girls.

daughter becomes mother. daughter remembers.